SEO Changelog — Dolphin Tours in Destin FL

URL: https://bikkinibottomboat.com/crab-island-tours-in-destin-fl-2-2-2-2/ · **WP ID:** 1457 (Elementor) · **Audit date:** 2026-10-25 · **Audit page 4 of 24**
Sources: WordPress/Elementor content and Rank Math fields (site connector), Semrush US rankings and keyword volumes, FAQ page (ID 2271).

> **Limitation:** the live page could not be fetched from the audit environment. Rendered-HTML items are marked **VERIFY**.

1. Summary

Area	Current state	Priority
Biggest opportunity on the site	The Destin dolphin cluster is large and relatively easy: **"destin dolphin cruise" 2,400/mo (KD 29)**, "dolphin cruise destin fl" 1,600 (KD 40), "dolphin cruise destin" 1,600, "destin dolphin tours" 880, "dolphin tours destin" 720, "dolphin tour destin fl" 390. That's more than 7,500 searches/month. The page ranks only #66 for "dolphin tour destin fl" and in the 17–22 range for a few "private dolphin" terms.	**High**
Thin, duplicate content	About 200 words. The main section is a **copy of the Sunset page** ("As the sun starts its descent..."), so the two pages compete for "sunset and dolphin tour". It says "2 Hour" where the Sunset page says "1.5 Hours", and nothing describes the **daytime** dolphin tour the FAQ says you offer.	**High**
Booking	The only Book Now opens the Sunset item (550732) with stale `/calendar/2025/03/` + `elementor-preview` parameters. There's no daytime dolphin booking link.	**High**
Slug	`/crab-island-tours-in-destin-fl-2-2-2-2/`, a page-copy artifact with "crab island" in a dolphin URL.	**High**
H1	"Dolphin Tours": no location, and the H2 "Dolphin Tours in Destin" is the stronger heading.	**Medium**
Keyword field	6 phrases, including 2 Fort Walton Beach terms and "sunset tour" (belongs to page 3).	**Medium**
Links / images	"Yes! Crab Island!" → wrong slug `/crab-island-tours/`. One image (a sunset PNG with a Fort Walton Beach / Beach Please alt). No dolphin photo on a dolphin page.	**High**
Freshness	Last modified 2025-03-26, the oldest of the service pages.	**Low**

2. Keyword targeting & cannibalization fix

Keyword	Vol.	KD	Now	Use

destin dolphin cruise	2,400	29	—	**Primary**: title, H1, slug
dolphin cruise destin fl / dolphin cruise destin	1,600 / 1,600	40 / 57	—	Covered by the primary term; use both in the intro and meta
destin dolphin tours / dolphin tours destin	880 / 720	47 / 45	—	Secondary: H2
dolphin tour destin fl	390–480	49	#66	Secondary
private dolphin tour(s) / cruise destin	40–50 each	—	#17–22	H3 private section, an easy page-1 win
swim with dolphins destin	720	16	—	Answer only as an FAQ ("No; here's why, and how to see them instead"). Don't promise swimming with dolphins: federal guidelines (NOAA) prohibit feeding or harassing wild dolphins.

> **Split between pages:** this page = **dolphin cruise / dolphin tours** (daytime + private, with an overview that points to the sunset option). Page 3 = **sunset** cruise terms. Remove the copied sunset paragraph here and replace it with a short teaser linking to page 3 with the anchor "sunset dolphin cruise".

3. URL & Rank Math changes

Field	Current	Change to
Slug	crab-island-tours-in-destin-fl-2-2-2-2	**destin-dolphin-cruise** + 301 from the old URL. (Replaces `/dolphin-tours-destin-fl/` suggested in the homepage changelog; the "cruise" phrasing has 3× the volume at lower difficulty.)
SEO title	Dolphin Tours in Destin FL - Bikkini Bottom Boat Charters	**Destin Dolphin Cruise & Dolphin Tours | Bikkini Bottom** (54)
Meta description	Experience the thrill of dolphin tours in Destin. Join us on an unforgettable adventure and get up close with these majestic creatures. Book now!	**Take a dolphin cruise in Destin, FL from Destin Harbor. Wild bottlenose dolphins spotted on most trips, BYOB, restroom onboard, free parking. Book online!** (151)
Focus keyword	dolphin tours in destin, sunset and dolphin tour fort walton beach fl, sunset and dolphin tour, dolphin tour fort walton beach, dolphin tour, sunset tour	**destin dolphin cruise**; secondary: dolphin cruise destin fl, destin dolphin tours, private dolphin tour destin
WP title	Dolphin Tours in Destin FL	**Destin Dolphin Cruise**
OG image	None	1200×630 dolphin photo (new upload needed)

4. Heading structure

Tag	Current	New
H1	Dolphin Tours	**Destin Dolphin Cruise**
H2	Dolphin Tours in Destin	**What to Expect on Our Dolphin Tours in Destin**
H2	Sunset Cruise and Dolphin Tour (copied from page 3)	**Choose Your Dolphin Cruise**
H3 (new)	"2 Hour Sunset & Dolphin Tour" (plain text)	**Daytime Dolphin Cruise**
H3 (new)	—	**Sunset Dolphin Cruise** (short teaser → page 3)
H3 (new)	—	**Private Dolphin Tour for Your Group**
H2 (new)	—	**About the Dolphins of Destin**
H2 (new)	—	**Tips for Spotting Dolphins**
H2 (new)	—	**Departure & Parking**
H2 (new)	—	**Destin Dolphin Cruise FAQs** (H3 per question)
H2	Want to See Crab Island Instead?	**Combine Dolphins with Crab Island**

5. Full rewritten page copy

[Brackets] = owner input. Confirm in FareHarbor that a daytime dolphin item exists. If it doesn't, the "Daytime Dolphin Cruise" section becomes "Dolphin Cruise (Sunset)" plus private-charter dolphin trips, and the FAQ page should stop listing "Daytime Dolphin Tours".

H1 Destin Dolphin Cruise

Watch wild bottlenose dolphins swim and play in their home waters on a **dolphin cruise in Destin, FL**. We leave from Destin Harbor aboard **Bikkini Bottom**, a 49-passenger charter boat with a restroom, shade and plenty of rail space for photos. Our captains know where the local pods feed, and most guests see dolphins on our trips. Bring your drinks and your camera.

[Book a Dolphin Cruise] [Call (850) 420-2540]

H2 What to Expect on Our Dolphin Tours in Destin

After check-in at 530 Harbor Blvd you'll walk right onto the boat. We idle out of Destin Harbor past the docks and boardwalk, then head toward the East Pass and Choctawhatchee Bay, where dolphins

often feed and travel. When the captain spots a pod, we slow down and let them come to us. You might see mothers with calves, dolphins surfing the boat's wake, or a group herding fish. The crew shares facts along the way and will take your photos. It's an easy, relaxed trip for all ages and a favorite with kids and grandparents.

H2 Choose Your Dolphin Cruise

H3 Daytime Dolphin Cruise

Best light for photos and calm afternoon water. **[Duration] · [$XX adults / $XX kids] · Departs [time(s)]**.

[Book Daytime Dolphin Cruise]

H3 Sunset Dolphin Cruise

Prefer dolphins with a sunset? Our 1.5-hour sunset dolphin cruise times the trip so the sun goes down over the harbor.

H3 Private Dolphin Tour for Your Group

Book the whole boat for a private dolphin tour from Destin Harbor for up to 49 guests: family reunions, birthdays, school groups or corporate outings. Add a stop at Crab Island or stay out for sunset. Call for group rates.

[Request a Private Dolphin Tour]

H2 About the Dolphins of Destin

The dolphins you'll see are **Atlantic bottlenose dolphins**, and many of them live in the Destin area all year. Adults grow 8–12 feet long, live 40+ years and often travel in small family groups. Researchers recognize individual dolphins by the nicks and notches on their dorsal fins. Federal law protects them, so we keep a respectful distance, never feed or chase them, and let the dolphins decide how close to come.

H2 Tips for Spotting Dolphins

- Watch for a curved dorsal fin breaking the surface, then a puff of spray as they breathe.
- Look for diving birds; dolphins and pelicans chase the same baitfish.
- Bring polarized sunglasses to cut glare and see beneath the surface.
- Set your phone to burst mode; dolphins surface for only a second or two.

H2 Departure & Parking

We depart from **530 Harbor Blvd, Destin, FL 32541**. Free parking is across Highway 98 at Craft Bar (541 US-98). Cross at the Benning Dr. light and walk to the marina. Don't park at the marina; vehicles may be towed. Full directions →

H2 Destin Dolphin Cruise FAQs

H3 Are dolphin sightings guaranteed?

No one can guarantee wildlife, but dolphins are common around Destin Harbor and most of our guests see them.

H3 Can you swim with dolphins in Destin?

Not with wild dolphins. NOAA guidelines prohibit feeding, touching or swimming with wild dolphins because it changes their behavior and puts them at risk. A dolphin cruise is the best way to see them up close in their natural habitat.

H3 What's the best time of day to see dolphins?

Dolphins are around all day. Morning and late-afternoon trips often have calmer water, which makes them easier to spot.

H3 Is the dolphin cruise good for kids?

Yes. It's one of our most family-friendly trips: walk-on boarding, restroom onboard and lifejackets for every size. [Owner: confirm infant/toddler lifejackets.]

H3 Can I bring food and drinks?

Yes. Bring snacks and drinks in a small cooler; guests 21+ may bring alcohol.

See all FAQs →

H2 Combine Dolphins with Crab Island

Want dolphins *and* a swim? Our Crab Island tours often pass dolphins on the way to the sandbar. Or book a private charter and do both.

New copy: about 850 words (up from about 200) and unique to this page. The copied sunset paragraph is gone.

6. Internal linking

Anchor	Target	Note
sunset dolphin cruise	/destin-sunset-dolphin-cruise/ (page 3, after its slug change)	new; sends sunset traffic to its own page
Crab Island tours	/crab-island-tours-in-destin-fl/	replaces the broken /crab-island-tours/
Full directions	/contact-bikkini-bottom-boat-charters/	new
See all FAQs	/faqs/	new
Inbound: "Destin dolphin cruise"	this page	From the homepage dolphin card, page 3 "Dolphins in Destin Harbor", the Crab Island page, the FAQ "Will I see dolphins?" answer, the footer "Daytime Dolphin Tour" link, and the "Is Crab Island safe for families" page. Add ILJ keywords: destin dolphin cruise, dolphin cruise, dolphin tours.

Inbound fix	Gallery page (ID 420) ranks #4 for "crab island dolphin tours"	Add a text link from the gallery to this page with anchor "dolphin tours" (covered in the gallery changelog).

7. Technical fixes

Issue	Fix	Priority
Booking link	Daytime button → `https://fareharbor.com/embeds/book/bikkinibottomboat/items/[daytime ID]/?full-items=yes`. Private → `…/items/550728/?full-items=yes&flow=1191550`. Remove the calendar/back parameters.	**High**
Slug + 301	Rename to `destin-dolphin-cruise`. Update the menu, footer and the homepage card. Check the Rank Math 404 monitor a week later.	**High**
Duplicate content	Delete the copied sunset paragraph (also on page 3). Replace with the unique copy above.	**High**
Images	Remove the sunset PNG, or keep it only in the Sunset teaser with alt **"Sunset dolphin cruise from Destin Harbor"**. Add 3–5 dolphin photos (WebP, 1024w, named e.g. `dolphins-destin-harbor-cruise.webp`). Alt examples: **"Bottlenose dolphin surfacing beside the Bikkini Bottom in Destin Harbor"**, **"Kids watching dolphins from the rail on a Destin dolphin cruise"**. Hero = `fetchpriority="high"`.	**High**
Video	The YouTube channel exists (@BIKKINIBOTTOMBOAT). Embed a 30–60 s dolphin clip with a lite-YouTube facade (click-to-load) so it doesn't hurt LCP, and add VideoObject schema.	**Low**
Canonical / sitemap	VERIFY self-canonical after the slug change; old URL out of the sitemap.	**Medium**

7a. Schema

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{
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 "name": "Destin Dolphin Cruise",
 "description": "Dolphin-watching cruise from Destin Harbor aboard the 49-passenger Bikkini Bottom.
Wild Atlantic bottlenose dolphins, BYOB, restroom onboard.",
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 "provider": {"@id": "https://bikkinibottomboat.com/#business"},
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   "url": "https://fareharbor.com/embeds/book/bikkinibottomboat/items/[ID]/"},
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"https://fareharbor.com/embeds/book/bikkinibottomboat/items/550728/"}
 ]
}
```

Add FAQPage (5 Q&As) and BreadcrumbList. Add VideoObject if a clip is embedded.

8. Tracking

Item	Setup
Book Now	`begin_checkout` with `tour_name` = dolphin_day / dolphin_private and `link_location` = dolphin_page.
Cross-sell click	`internal_tour_click` when visitors click the Sunset teaser or Crab Island link. This shows whether dolphin-intent visitors book something else.
Video	If embedded: GA4 enhanced measurement video events (or a GTM YouTube trigger) for start/50%/complete.
Rank tracking	destin dolphin cruise, dolphin cruise destin fl, destin dolphin tours, dolphin tours destin, private dolphin tour destin. Baseline today: not in the top 50 for any of the main terms.

9. Changelog (implementation checklist)

#	Change	Where	Status
1	Slug → destin-dolphin-cruise + 301; menu, footer and homepage links updated	WP / Rank Math	To do
2	SEO title, meta, focus keyword ("destin dolphin cruise"); FWB and sunset terms removed	Rank Math	To do
3	H1 → "Destin Dolphin Cruise"; new H2/H3 structure	Elementor	To do
4	Copied sunset text removed; about 850 words of unique dolphin copy added	Elementor	To do
5	Daytime + private Book Now links (correct item IDs, no stale params)	Elementor	To do
6	Duration conflict resolved (sunset = 1.5 h everywhere)	Elementor	To do
7	Internal links + ILJ keywords; broken /crab-island-tours/ fixed	Elementor / ILJ	To do
8	3–5 dolphin photos (WebP, descriptive alt); optional dolphin video	Media	To do
9	TouristTrip + FAQPage + Breadcrumb (+ VideoObject) schema; OG image	Rank Math	To do
10	Tracking events + rank-tracking baseline	GTM / Semrush	To do
11	Owner input: does a daytime dolphin item exist? duration, price, times; toddler lifejackets	Owner	Waiting

Next page in queue: **FAQs** (/faqs/, ID 2271).